

ALKA MAHAPATRA

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Professional Highlights

- **5+ years across Product Design and UX Research**, spanning consumer, B2B SaaS, enterprise, eCommerce, fintech, accessibility, and 0→1 products.
- Lead work from **discovery and research through requirements, IA, user flows, prototyping, usability testing, high-fidelity UI, Engineering collaboration, and iteration.**
- Experienced with **user interviews, stakeholder interviews, surveys, diary studies, contextual inquiry, usability testing, heuristic evaluation, ethnography, and mixed-methods synthesis.**
- Led design across a **1.5M+ user ecosystem**, contributing to **+10.6% web conversion, +50% app conversion, -18% bounce rate, +35% engagement, and +7 min. average session duration.**
- Proficient in **Figma, Adobe Photoshop, and Adobe Illustrator**, with experience building design systems, responsive products, native-mobile experiences, complex workflows, and accessible interfaces.
- AI-forward designer using **Claude, Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, ChatGPT, and GenAI workflows** for research synthesis, product exploration, functional prototyping, accessibility review, and developer handoff.
- Led and mentored **3 designers** and collaborated with Product, Engineering, Analytics, Marketing, Research, executives, clients, and domain SMEs.

Skills

- **UX Research:** User Interviews • Stakeholder Interviews • Surveys • Diary Studies • Contextual Inquiry • Ethnography • Usability Testing • Heuristic Evaluation • Competitive Analysis • Journey Mapping • Personas • Affinity Mapping • Research Synthesis • Qualitative & Quantitative Insights
- **Product & UX Design:** Product Discovery • Problem Framing • Information Architecture • User Flows • Interaction Design • Wireframing • High-Fidelity UI • Responsive Web • Native Mobile • Complex Workflows • Internal Tools • Dashboards • 0→1 Products
- **Experimentation & Analytics:** A/B Testing • Funnel Analysis • Behavioral Analytics • Heatmaps • Session Recordings • Conversion Optimization • GA4 • Hotjar • Microsoft Clarity
- **Design Systems & Delivery:** Figma • Auto Layout • Components • Variants • Variables • Component Properties • Responsive Patterns • Figma Dev Mode • Design QA • Developer Handoff • Agile
- **AI & Prototyping:** Claude • Claude Code • Cursor • ChatGPT • Gemini • Figma AI • Figma Make • Base44 • Lovable • v0 • Replit • GitHub Copilot
- **Technical & Creative:** Git/GitHub • VS Code • HTML/CSS • JavaScript Familiarity • Adobe Photoshop • Illustrator • InDesign • After Effects • ProtoPie • Rive • Miro • FigJam
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.2 AA • Section 508 • EN 301 549 • VPAT • VoiceOver • NVDA • TalkBack • Voice Access • Axe • WAVE

Relevant Work Experience

UX Consultant, Cocoon Technologies - USA (Remote)

Jan 2026 - Present

- Conduct research across multiple user and stakeholder groups and translate findings into product requirements, journeys, workflows, interaction models, and functional prototypes for an accessibility-first mobile and web product.
- Design complex experiences spanning live communication, permissions, documents, sensitive information, consent, notifications, emergency contacts, escalation, and history, balancing usability, accessibility, privacy, safety, and technical feasibility.

Product Designer & UX Researcher, Haptiq - New York

June 2025 - June 2026

- Owned work from discovery and research through IA, user flows, prototypes, high-fidelity UI, design systems, Engineering handoff, and design QA across enterprise, B2B SaaS, consumer, and operational products.
- Conducted and synthesized user/stakeholder interviews, contextual inquiry, usability testing, surveys, heuristic evaluations, competitive analysis, and affinity mapping, turning evidence into prioritized product opportunities and design decisions.
- Designed complex workflows, dashboards, internal tools, pricing interfaces, service-ticketing systems, product configuration, navigation, filters, and CMS/admin experiences, simplifying information for both expert and occasional users.
- Built reusable Figma systems using Auto Layout, components, variants, variables, and component properties, partnering closely with Product, Engineering, clients, executives, SMEs, and data partners through feasibility discussions and implementation.
- Explored various AI-assisted workflows to pressure-test assumptions, identify edge cases, and rapidly make product behavior tangible.

UX Designer (Accessibility), Michigan Publishing - Michigan, USA

Feb 2025 - May 2025

- Conducted accessibility-focused UX evaluations using WCAG 2.2 AA, Section 508, EN 301 549, VoiceOver, NVDA, TalkBack, Axe, WAVE, keyboard testing, and manual review.
- Evaluated navigation, semantics, forms, focus behavior, content structure, typography, spacing, and assistive-technology interactions to identify barriers affecting real users.
- Translated findings into prioritized remediation guidance, VPAT-related documentation, training materials, and roadmap inputs, balancing user impact, compliance requirements, technical feasibility, and implementation effort.

UX Lead & Manager (1y 1m), promoted from UX/UI Designer (7m), Transformative Ventures - India

Oct 2022 – May 2024

- Led Product/UX Design and mentored 3 designers across a 1.5M+ user web and native-mobile wellness ecosystem, spanning product discovery, personalization, recommendations, PDPs, cart, checkout, onboarding, tracking, engagement, and retention.
- Combined surveys, customer feedback, A/B testing, funnel analysis, heatmaps, session recordings, and behavioral analytics to identify friction and prioritize product improvements.
- Contributed to +10.6% web conversion, +50% app conversion, -18% bounce rate, +35% engagement, ~\$100K app impact, and +7 minutes average session duration through research-informed design and experimentation.
- Partnered with Product, Engineering, Analytics, Marketing, Content, and leadership to translate customer behavior and business goals into product priorities, experiments, interaction improvements, and shipped experiences.

UX Designer, Network for Conserving Central India - India

Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

- Conducted stakeholder interviews, content audits, usability evaluation, and information-architecture analysis to uncover navigation, accessibility, and discoverability problems across a complex information ecosystem.
- Translated research into prioritized UX recommendations, revised IA, user flows, wireframes, and accessibility improvements.

Associate UX/UI Designer, Kandle (formerly dRisk) - India

Jul 2022 – Aug 2022

- Partnered directly with the founder and developers on a 0→1 fintech product, translating emerging business and user needs into responsive flows, dashboards, wireframes, prototypes, and foundational interaction patterns.
- Worked iteratively in an early-stage environment, balancing customer needs, business priorities, usability, visual design, and technical feasibility.

Associate Graphic Designer, Trendgully - India

Mar 2022 – Apr 2022

- Translated fashion forecasts, streetwear trends, visual culture and client briefs into consumer-facing graphics and merchandise concepts, balancing aesthetic direction with audience and commercial requirements.

- Developed visual concepts using Adobe Creative Suite across fashion and eCommerce contexts, strengthening expertise in composition, typography, color and culturally relevant visual storytelling.

Senior Executive - Graphic Designer (10m), converted from Design Intern (4m), Blackberrys Menswear - India

Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Designed and maintained visual systems across a national fashion brand's product communication, packaging, retail collateral, catalogs, garment tags and brand touchpoints, applying strong typography, composition, hierarchy, iconography and production craft.
- Partnered with Design, sourcing, category and production teams to translate brand and merchandising requirements into scalable artwork and production-ready specifications.
- Redesigned a fragmented system of 3–8 garment tags into one cohesive information system, reducing annual printing/production cost by 62% while maintaining brand and product-information requirements.

Research Analyst, Arvora - India

Nov 2020 – Dec 2020

- Conducted ethnographic fieldwork, contextual inquiry, artisan interviews, and secondary research for Odisha Silver Filigree documentation.
- Synthesized cultural, historical, material, and production insights into structured research supporting the broader GI initiative.

Education

- **Master of Science in Information (UX Research & Design), University of Michigan - Ann Arbor**

2024-2026

Focus: Interaction Design • User-Centered Design • Responsive Web • UX Research • Information Architecture • Accessibility | GPA: 4.0 / 4.0
- **Bachelor of Design, National Institute of Fashion Technology - New Delhi**

2017-2021

Focus: Fashion & Consumer Research • Visual Communication • Typography • Layout • Color • Graphic Design • Trend Research • Brand Storytelling • Photography • Product Development | GPA: 8.0 / 10.0

Award

Founder, Product Designer & Team Lead | Pitch2Win 2025 First Place Winner, Thryve Health Management App

Oct 2025 – Nov 2025

- Took a 0→1 AI-assisted health-management concept through secondary research, competitive benchmarking, value proposition, feature prioritization, TAM/SAM/SOM, pricing, business model, GTM, technology options, wireframes, AI prototype, branding, pitch development, and financial modeling.
- Won 1st Place among 17 teams at Pitch2Win 2025.

AI-enabled UX Workflows

- Built reusable **Claude Skills** to support UX research workflows, synthesis, alternative hypotheses, and critique.
- Use AI as a **devil’s advocate** to uncover assumptions, edge cases, accessibility concerns, conflicting logic, and overlooked user needs.
- Generate and compare alternate user flows, then pressure-test them against **personas, scenarios, product requirements, and technical constraints**.
- Use **Claude Code, Figma Make, Base44 and v0** to move from static concepts toward functional prototypes through a **build → test → regenerate → refine** workflow.
- Apply AI to UX writing, accessibility review, interaction documentation, frontend exploration, and Engineering handoff while keeping final judgment grounded in user evidence and research.